

Lititz BMX: Fireside BMX Chat Podcast Plan

Host: Kyle A. Huffman
Guest: Linda Leary Taylor

Introduction

Thank you for considering being a guest on my podcast. This podcast grew from a lack of an outlet for a retired Instructional Designer, Veteran, and BMX hack. Really, the perfect storm as you will most likely learn soon.

So, here is the lead-up timeline:

- Aug 2024: I purchased a Radical Rick trophy (plaque) on eBay, for my RR collection, and asked the seller who earned it. I was told "I purchased Harry Leary's storage unit last year". I looked around and on faith bought a few more items before buying my first "lot" from the seller.

I shared that purchases were made, with the seller by name, in two facebook groups and was met with crickets (August 24th). No one cared. I was told it was a "fool's investment" and laughed at or ignored. I have purchased four lots now and plan on purchasing more as the opportunity arises; the seller and I have developed a friendship. I don't know what he has in inventory, I am going mostly on blind faith when available.

- Suddenly, starting September 7th, everyone cared but I was asked not to participate in other groups and respectfully withdrew.
- So, I started The Unofficial Harry Leary Fireside Chat Group on Facebook and began developing content to support the page, with goals of:
1) enhancing my understanding of my own collection, 2) giving myself a "retired professional" outlet (creativity not financial), and 3) developing and nurturing a living Harry Leary Body of Knowledge that includes open discussions, perhaps a place to work through grief of his passing and many issues created during his life, and public validation and verification of Harry Leary items.

This podcast is the next step in the evolution of this program.

Conversation Outline

Setting the stage:

This podcast draws inspiration from many hours as a kid spent listening to cassettes of old radio programs - where you had to use a bit of imagination but the stories were amazing. Throw in content awareness from Howard Stern and you have the show's core foundation. It pairs that with a stage that draws inspiration from our Facebook group's fireside chat theme. This podcast's theme will be based on a fireside chat held while walking towards Harry Leary's Lake Havasu paver to stomp it!

Think of this as a limited movie experience disguised as an interview, just without video.

Introduction: The sounds of three sets of footprints lead the listener on a journey of discovery. Two sets are adult, one is that of a child. As they walk, they begin to talk...

****I don't believe listeners should be subjected to a long over produced intro that does nothing to actually enhance the content.****

This podcast will provide a brief introduction consisting of: 1) setting the stage, 2) background audio of three sets of footprints and natural sounds found on a walk, 3) loose following of a facilitated conversation to learn about Harry Leary from his sister's perspective, and a memorial point.

Think & Imagine: Two people are out on a walk in with a 22 month old, doing what people do - Two new friends talking: Simple - Friendly - Growth - Enhanced Understanding

Episode Roadmap - The Actual Conversation

- Intro: Walking towards Harry's paver at the Lake Havasu canal's Memorial Walkway
 - Note: Kyle and Anne-Marie are standing outside of London-Bridge Harley Davidson at the base of the London Bridge in Lake Havasu City, Az
 - Kyle: "Anne-Marie, look at that. It is the London Bridge."
 - Kyle: "You know, like the song. Yeah!"
 - Linda: "Kyle, is that you and Anne-Marie?"
 - Kyle: "Linda! Hi! It is nice to finally meet you."
 - Kyle: "Using the London-Bridge Harley Davidson store as our meet-up was a good choice, it was easy to find."
 - Kyle: "We used to collect the Harley store decals for my father-in-law so we always get a smile when we see one now."
 - Kyle: "Anne-Marie is going to join us on our walk today. I am going to let you know that this may be a challenge, she is still in the toddling phase."
 - Kyle: "Well, if you are ready, lets do this."
 - Kyle: "I can't believe we are about to cross the London Bridge. I promise I will try to suppress my desire to sing the song."
 - Kyle: "I guess we will go up and make a loop then find the paver?"
 - Kyle: "Alright ladies, let's do this! Lead the way."
- Harry & Linda growing up
 - Kyle: "Do you mind taking me back and sharing a bit about your childhood and being Harry's younger sister?"
 - Kyle: "You are 18 months younger than Harry?"
 - Kyle: "And you also have a younger sister?"
 - Kyle: "What's your earliest memory of your brother?"
 - Kyle: "Did you look up to him, or fear him when you two were young?"
 - Kyle: "As you two grew-up, how did the two of you's relationship develop?"
 - Kyle: "Ok, so I asked about your earliest memory, but what is your favorite memory of Harry from before BMX?"
 - Kyle: "If you could go back and spend a day with Harry as kids, before all of this BMX stuff, how would you two have the perfect day?"
- Transition
 - Kyle: (whisper) "Wow, look at that kiddo! This is it? We are about to step foot on the London Bridge."
 - Kyle: "I read that they brought this here in 1971 but it was built originally in 1831."
 - Kyle: "I almost didn't believe that it existed."
 - Kyle: "Everyone also says, I have a bridge to sell you. This one was actually sold and relocated here from London?"
 - Kyle: "Do you have a favorite spot you like to look at from this bridge?"

- Harry got into BMX:
 - Kyle: "Something just popped into my head. What is this I hear that Harry's first bike was actually a horse?"
 - Kyle: "Just a curious question, My cousin still has all of his old hot wheels, Star Wars, and Becketts because my Aunt kept all of that. Is your Mom one of those that held onto things, like that horse?"
 - Kyle: "I was curious whether or not she still had it."
 - Kyle: "Can you please share with me the progression of his BMX from riding the horse to just before Harry turned professional?"
 - Kyle: "It is my understanding that your parents only went to one or two of Harry's races. How do you think that affected him?"
 - Kyle: "Knowing what your Mom knows now, do you think, or has she expressed regret for not attending more races?"
 - Kyle: "He worked at Coates right? Can you tell me a little more about that - the sign is iconic!"
 - Kyle: "Did you have a Schwinn too to start like Harry did?"
 - Kyle: "How far did your BMX career get?"
- Transition
 - Kyle: The bridge basically goes over this canal here and connects the mainland to this island right?
 - Kyle: "Do you mind if we take a quick water and view break?"
 - Note: <Anne's water bottle 'pop'>
 - Kyle: "Here you go kiddo."
 - Kyle: <whispers>"How cool is this Anne. We are on the London Bridge."
 - Kyle: "Yeah, like the song....London bridges falling down." "Don't sing Daddy?"
 - Kyle: "I swear Linda, she normally likes my singing."
 - Kyle: "Wow, look at that view! Both sides."
 - Kyle: "Do they light this up at night?"
 - Kyle: "Anne and I may have to come back to see that."
- Harry becoming professional and "leaving" the family after joining Diamondback:
 - Kyle: "So, then Harry started to ride for JMC and turned professional?"
 - Kyle: "What do you remember of that era? The JMC era"
 - Kyle: "Then Harry left JMC for Diamondback. Is that when you started to lose touch with Harry or was it before?"
 - Kyle: "As his younger sister, how did you feel about him personally for leaving?"
 - Kyle: "How did your younger sister take it and what was their relationship like?"
- Transition
 - Kyle "Look at that, we made it across. Wow, how fun was that Anne?"
 - Kyle: "I guess we should cross the street and head toward Harry's paver?"
 - Kyle: "I am curious to see the different perspectives of the bridge."

- Harry returning to the family
 - Kyle: "So, sorry, do you mind me asking about Harry coming back to the family, for lack of a better way to say this or understanding, and was "involved" again?"
 - Kyle: "Harry really became a family man?" - "like wife, kids, and all?"
 - Kyle: "Do you mind sharing of his "immediate family"?"
 - Kyle: "I believe he was married once, he was also in a long term relationship, and in one that is a little more well known in the BMX community, and has a couple of kids?"
 - Kyle: "I am hoping you can clarify something for me, Jami, how do you pronounce that?, Owen was his first wife?"
 - Kyle: "She said that he was a dancer, believe it or not"
 - Kyle: "But, I did read a quote of his a while back, which was "Grab her some times and dance with her. With no music, randomly on the street. Dance."
 - Kyle: "Speaking of Jami, do you mind me asking about a post she made?"
 - Kyle: "I hear a lot of talk about Harry being abusive. I also see that the majority of his defenders are women - including one that many try to hold up as who he was abusing - not Jami - and by the way, that is all community speculation true or untrue in my opinion, I just want to understand."
 - Kyle: "In your understanding, did Harry Leary ever use his fists in anger against a woman? Not in self-defense, but in anger or rage?"
 - Kyle: "I know that Shelly, while not married, is still referred to as Harry's wife by the family."
 - Kyle: "Do you mind sharing a little more about Shelly and their relationship?"
 - Kyle: "And him and Patty were kind of epic from what I have learned but she was at his celebration of life?"
 - Kyle: "It is beautiful that she attended."
- Transition
 - Kyle: "1 sec Linda. Anne look over there. See the hot air balloons?"
 - Kyle: "I have actually never been on a hot air balloon ride."
 - Kyle: "Have you ever ridden in one?"
 - Kyle: "If I had a parachute for Harry to jump out of the hot air balloon on his bike, would he have taken me up on the opportunity?"
- Harry passing:
 - Kyle: "I apologize but do you mind if I ask you a few more personal or potentially difficult to answer questions?"
 - Kyle: "You were notified by the Police of Harry's passing?"

- Kyle: "Do you mind walking me through that scene and say, perhaps, the following 48-hours in your world?"
- Kyle: "My understanding is that you were reaching out to Harry's contacts trying to put pieces together?"
- Kyle: "One person you contacted was Greg Mathias?"
- Kyle: "He told me that you were kind of giving him the third degree at first because you didn't know who he was?"
 - Kyle: "What was going through your mind as you were talking with Greg for that first time?"
- Kyle: "What was the rest of the search or I guess knowledge quest, for lack of a better way to say that, like for you?"
 - Kyle: "Did you learn anything during that time frame that surprised you - post mortem - that you don't mind sharing - outside of BMX?"
- Since Harry died:
 - Kyle: "Since Harry died, what has become your and your Mom's understanding of Harry's impact on the sport of BMX, and really even Mountain Biking - I guess cycling?"
 - Kyle: "Have you found closure?"
- Look to the future of his legacy
 - Kyle: "As you look towards the future, what do you hope his legacy is?"
- One word:
 - Kyle: "Ok, so I like to play this game called "One Word." are you down?"
 - Kyle: "One word to describe Harry Leary as a brother?"
 - Kyle: "One word for what you believe your brother, Harry Leary, was able to achieve as a BMX legend?"
- Transition
 - Kyle: "Anne, we are getting close to the end of the bridge."
 - Kyle: "What an experience! Thank you for agree to meet up here and chat"
 - Linda: "The memorial walkway is just right down there."
 - Kyle: "What a cool concept. How long ago did they build this walkway?" (2008)
 - Kyle: "Do you know anything about the back story on it?"
- Conclusion:
 - Linda: "We are almost there."
 - Kyle: "Is that it?"... "The paver?"
 - Kyle: <Stomp>
 - Kyle: "Is that how you do it?"
 - Kyle: "Hahahahaha... Never in my life would I have guessed that I would be crossing the London Bridge to stomp on Harry Leary's memory..."
 - Kyle: "But, in all actuality, It is very humbling standing here looking at it."

- Kyle: "And you take this walk 2 to 3 times per week?"
- Kyle: "Do you mind sharing with me how you reflect when you walk down to this paver?"
- Kyle: "What is the backstory on the paver and how did it get here?"
- Kyle: "It really is an amazing spot!"
- Kyle: "I think we are going to need to get Anne-Marie back for a nap soon."
- Kyle: "Thank you for the company during our walk. It was amazing learning more about everything we talked about today, and honestly this has been really healing."
- Kyle: "Are you down to do this again someday?"
- Kyle: "Cool, we will figure it out. I want to see his tree and hear about that when we get a chance."
- Kyle: "Till then, It's a date."
- Kyle: "I look forward to learning more. Bye bye."

--- End of Recording ---

Connecting and Recording

We will connect by phone. Once connected, I will place the call on speaker and begin the recording on my iPhone. This is done to allow for a clear/clean local recording and redundancy with other external recording devices.

The great thing about being an audio focused podcast is that we have the liberty of editing pretty easy. I can easily:

- Clear-up most "Um's" "Ah's" "Uh's" etc. Even a cough. I just ask that you think to leave me a buffer to clean things up - just a brief moment if you can.
- If you make an error, or misspeak, don't like how something came out, or your wife opens the door and asks for you to pick up milk... It is ok, we can pause and you can reframe your thoughts and I will edit accordingly.

Please make sure you are in as quiet of a room as possible - life happens but driving down the 10 with the top down does not make for a good recording. If you have a headset, please use it. I'll probably have my daughter, so - professional, I know.

The power of editing is a wonderful thing.

A Little About Kyle

Kyle is a late 70's baby and has all of the likes and quirks of one who grew up in The SF East Bay during that time frame. Like most of his generation, he's kind of a hodgepodge of eclectic stirrings. But, there are those who love him regardless.

So... Here are:

Five "Interesting" Facts

- 1) He has hired over 1000 people and even developed an employment path for "unqualified" candidates that had a good personality, as a Silicon Valley tech company direct hiring manager during high growth pre and post IPO periods. This team went on to earn SC Magazine Awards 3 of his 4 years for "Industry Best Customer Service".
- 2) Kyle inherited a pet piranha.
- 3) His collection of 13 BMX bikes and fun memorabilia has him wanting to open a museum eventually - *"I'm a "retired" Instructional Designer and one of my Master Degrees is in Education with a focus on Online Teaching & Learning so it is the perfect retirement job."*
- 4) He is the son of a former Hells Angel who went to prison when Kyle was two years old.
- 5) He founded the Veterans Employee Resource Group (VERG) for a major financial institution and within 3 years the group earned a Secretary of Defense Employer Support Freedom Award.
- 6) He had his first daughter at the age of 44. She is the blessing of his life and he is grateful that he is able to be a Stay-at-Home Dad with her. Their current thing is Ms. Rachel.

You said five - Oh, you caught that...

He is a 100% VA Disabled Veteran who deployed twice onboard the USS Oldendorf (DD-972) - earning the Enlisted Surface Warfare (ESWS) designator, earned the designator of Master Training Specialist (MTS) while stationed at the Naval Security Group Activity (NSGA)/Cryptologic Readiness Group (CRG), and served as a Senior Consultant: Cryptologic Intelligence Collection Operations at the Space and Naval Warfare Command (SPAWAR) - Under NSA tasking & is a "451" graduate (Intermediate Signal Analyst).

Ok, so... LinkedIn stuff over. I've done a lot but I have my demons. I have over 6 years of sobriety from alcohol. Shortly after quitting drinking, I discovered I was Bi-Polar 1 - the fight of my life began. It's a long story that nearly cost me everything, hell - I nearly threw it all away. Nearly...

My Story finds hope

Conclusion

Thank you. I look forward to hearing back from you.